

Lemon Curd Tarts MINI

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Lemon Curd Tartlets



These Lemon Curd Tartlets are a delicious and fancy little dessert to serve for a party or afternoon tea. Buttery, crunchy and oh so tangy, these Mini Lemon Tarts combine a homemade shortcrust pastry and creamy lemon curd into a delicious bite!

Ingredients

Tartlet Shells

- 250 gr All-Purpose / Plain Flour
- 50 gr Icing Sugar, *sifted*
- 1 pinch Fine Salt
- 120 gr Unsalted Butter, *cold*
- 1 large Egg, *at room temperature*

Lemon Curd

- 4 Egg Yolks
- 100 gr Caster Sugar, *or fine white granulated sugar*
- 125 ml Lemon Juice, *about 3 large lemons*
- 75 gr Unsalted Butter, *at room temperature*
- 1 Lemon Zest, *optional*
- .5% Xanthan Gum *by weight (370g total weight means using 1.8g Xanthan Gum)*

Instructions

Tartlet Shells

- Place the Flour, Icing Sugar and Salt in the bowl of your Food Processor and pulse to mix (*see note 1 if making by hands*). Add the cold Butter cut into small cubes, then mix to get very small crumbs.
- Whisk the egg in a separate bowl and add it to the food processor. Slowly pulse until a dough starts to come together (*see note 2*).
- Bring the dough together into a ball and roll between two sheets of baking paper to be about 4 mm or 1/6 inch thick. Place on a flat tray and leave in the fridge to chill and rest for at least 1 hour, or up to 24 hours.
- Remove the baking paper. With a round or fluted cookie cutter that is about 1.5 to 2 cm (0.6 to 0.8 inch) wider than the opening of the muffin pan, cut out disks of pastry (*see note 3*). Gently slide the disks of pastry into a muffin pan and lightly press on the bottom corners to make sure the pastry is touching the pan all around - and to remove any air bubbles that could be trapped under the pastry.
Pro tip: use a muffin pan with perforated bottom to insure an even air flow and optimal baking with minimal shrinkage.
- Place back in the fridge to rest and chill for at least 2 hour - preferably overnight.
- Preheat your oven on 160°C/325°F. Prick the bottom of the pastries with a fork and place the muffin pan in the freezer while the oven is preheating.
- Line each tartlet shells with a small piece of crunched up baking paper and fill with baking beads, rice or beans. Bake for 15 minutes, then remove the weights and baking paper and bake for another 15 minutes, or until golden and dry to the touch. Set aside to cool down completely.

Lemon Curd

- Place the Egg Yolks, Sugar and Lemon Juice in a small pot. Whisk to combine then turn on very low to low heat. Whisk for a few minutes or until the liquid looks like it is starting to thicken - about 3 to 5 minutes.
- Cut the butter into small cubes and slowly add them to the pot. Whisk until melted and combined each time before adding more. Weigh the mixture and add the Lemon Zest and .5% Xanthan gum. Note: weigh the pot before starting to substrate it's weight from the total weight at this point.
- Cook on low heat for 5 to 30 minutes or until the curd has thickened. Continuously whisk to avoid lumps (*see note 4*).
- To check if the curd is cooked, dip the back of a spoon into the curd then draw a line in the curd with your fingers (be careful, it will be hot). Tip the spoon down and check if any of the curd is dripping down over the clear line. If the line stays clear, the curd is ready. If the curd pours over the line, it needs to cook for longer.

Assembling the Lemon Tarts

- While still warm, pour the curd into the tartlet shells. Gently tap each tartlet against a hard surface to remove any air bubbles, then place in the fridge to set for at least 2 to 3 hours (*see note 5*).

Instruction Notes:

1. If you don't have a food processor, you can make the pastry by hands or using a pastry blender. You can find the detailed step by step instructions on how to make the dough by hands [here](#).
2. Avoid overworking the pastry by stopping as soon as part of the pastry comes together. To know it is mixed enough, press some lumps of pastry between your hand. If they should stick together, the pastry is ready. If too dry, add a little bit of very cold water. If very sticky, add a little bit more flour.
3. The wider you cut out the circles of pastry, the deeper the tartlet shells will be. It is up to you how wide you cut them out, but I recommend having the width of the muffin pan openings as a minimum. Otherwise, the crusts will be quite flat and not deep enough for a filling.
4. The time it will take for the curd to be cooked will depend on the heat of your stove. You should always cook a curd on very low heat to avoid burning it or getting lumps.
5. You could also make the lemon curd in advance (up to 3 days in advance) and slightly reheat it up to fill the tartlets on the day you need them. Either reheat on a double-boiler, or for a few seconds in the microwave (but be careful not to reheat for too long or you might cook it).

